

MacroLens Daily Brief — August 04, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. Oil prices tumble after Bessent says Strait of Hormuz deal may come this week

CNBC — 2026-08-04 15:57

Oil prices fell sharply after Treasury Secretary Bessent signaled a possible US-Iran deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz within days; Brent slid 5.3% to \$79.36, WTI fell 5.7% to \$75.77, though analysts doubt a lasting agreement and see limited upside for oil flows.

2. Oil prices settle 5% lower after claims of progress in US-Iran talks - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-04 01:02

Oil prices settled 5% lower following reports of progress in US-Iran talks over the Strait of Hormuz, reflecting reduced geopolitical risk premium in crude markets.

3. Goldman sees Brent at \$80-\$90 until US-Iran deal or major escalation - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-04 08:45

Goldman Sachs forecasts Brent crude will trade in an \$80-\$90 range until either a US-Iran deal is reached or a major escalation occurs, highlighting the market's sensitivity to geopolitical developments.

4. Aramco says US-Iran war has cost the global market 2.6 billion barrels of oil - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-04 05:32

Saudi Aramco stated the US-Iran war has removed 2.6 billion barrels of oil from the global market, underscoring the significant supply disruption and its impact on global inventories and prices.

5. EXCLUSIVE: US has used 'virtually all' of its long-range precision missiles during Iran war, sources say - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-04 16:16

The US has reportedly used 'virtually all' of its long-range precision missiles during the Iran war, a potential constraint on future military actions and a factor that could affect geopolitical risk assessments in energy markets.

6. Qatar says mediators make progress in efforts to end US-Iran war - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-08-04 21:23

Qatar reported that mediators are making progress in efforts to end the US-Iran war, a

development that could reduce oil supply risks and pressure crude prices lower if a ceasefire materializes.

7. **Iran demands inbound control of Hormuz and outbound oversight, source says - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-08-04 13:46

Iran is demanding control over inbound traffic and oversight of outbound traffic in the Strait of Hormuz, a key sticking point in negotiations that could determine the pace of oil flow normalization.

8. **BP's quarterly profit doubles to over \$5 billion after Iran war oil surge - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-08-04 06:09

BP's quarterly profit doubled to over \$5 billion, driven by the surge in oil prices following the Iran war, reflecting strong upstream earnings and higher realized crude prices.

9. **Lufthansa warns profits could fall as Iran war stokes fuel costs - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-08-04 05:06

Lufthansa warned that profits could fall as the Iran war stokes fuel costs, highlighting the negative impact of elevated oil prices on airlines and other fuel-intensive sectors.

10. **Stocks jump to records after upbeat company forecasts; oil, yen weaken - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-08-04 00:38

Global stocks jumped to record highs on upbeat company forecasts, while oil weakened and the yen fell, indicating risk-on sentiment driven by corporate earnings and easing geopolitical tensions.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	757.67	+1.42%	bullish
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	700.07	+1.76%	bullish
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	531.22	+1.32%	bullish
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	296.22	+1.72%	bullish
XLK	Technology ETF	178.04	+1.53%	bullish
XLF	Financials ETF	57.38	+0.77%	bullish
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	81.77	+0.03%	neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	92.82	+0.20%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	82.19	+0.33%	neutral
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	106.11	+0.30%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.31	+0.27%	neutral
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	371.71	+0.05%	neutral
SLV	Silver ETF	52.46	+0.19%	neutral
USO	Oil ETF	122.12	-5.46%	bearish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.11	+0.50%	neutral
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.17	+0.00%	neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	106.19	-0.20%	neutral
FXJ	Japanese Yen ETF	58.50	+1.46%	bullish
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	63460.90	-0.03%	neutral
ETH-USD	Ethereum	1858.26	-1.29%	bearish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate Target	3.5% – 3.75%	2026-08-04
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.23	2026-08-04
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.43	2026-08-04
VIX	15.86	2026-08-03
USD Index (Broad)	119.7034	2026-07-31

Major Anomalies

USO — Oil ETF -5.46%

Cause: Oil prices fell sharply due to progress in US-Iran ceasefire talks and easing geopolitical tensions in the Middle East, reducing supply disruption risks.

Forward Impact: Further declines possible if diplomatic efforts continue, but volatility may persist with ongoing regional conflicts and potential supply adjustments.

Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: <https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-08-04&to=2026-08-12&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong>]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map

Sector Performance Heatmap			
	1D	5D	1M
Energy	-1.3%	+0.7%	+10.5%
Financials	+0.8%	+0.9%	+3.2%
Communication Services	+2.9%	+3.4%	+1.6%
Real Estate	+0.2%	-1.3%	+1.1%
Consumer Discretionary	+1.8%	+6.7%	+0.9%
Consumer Staples	-0.2%	-0.6%	-0.1%
Industrials	+1.9%	-0.0%	-0.4%
Healthcare	-0.2%	-0.7%	-0.9%
Technology	+1.5%	+2.1%	-1.4%
Materials	+1.1%	-0.7%	-1.9%
Utilities	+0.0%	-2.9%	-3.1%

Hot Now

- **XLE** — Strong 1-month momentum (+10.5%) and positive 5-day trend despite short-term pullback.
- **XLC** — Leading across all timeframes with accelerating gains (1d +2.9%, 5d +3.4%).
- **XLY** — Robust 5-day surge (+6.7%) and positive 1-day, indicating renewed consumer spending.

Cold but Worth Watching

- **XLU** — Significant 1-month decline (-3.1%) and negative 5-day trend, but stable 1-day suggests possible stabilization.

- **XLB** — Negative 1-month (-1.9%) and 5-day (-0.7%) but positive 1-day (+1.1%) hints at short-term bounce potential.
- **XLRE** — Weak 5-day (-1.3%) and 1-month (+1.1%) underperformance, but 1-day positive and defensive appeal may attract flows.

Momentum favors cyclical growth and communication services, while defensive and rate-sensitive sectors show potential mean-reversion opportunities.

Daily Conclusion

Oil prices are the dominant macro theme, with a potential Strait of Hormuz deal driving a sharp selloff in energy (USO, XLE) while investors rotate into defensive and consumer sectors.

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